

Arabic Consonants on the IPA Table ¹

	Manner	Nasal	Plosive		Fricative		Trill	Approximant
Place			Unvoiced ¹	Voiced	Unvoiced	Voiced		
◌Labial		م [mīm, m]		ب [bāʾ, b]	ف [fāʾ, f] (labiodental)			
◌Dental					ث [thāʾ, θ]	ذ [dhāl, ð]		
◌Denti-Alveolar	plain	ن [nūn, n]	ت [tāʾ, t]	د [dāl, d]	س [sīn, s]	ز [zāy, z]	ر [rāʾ, r]	ل [lām, l] (Lateral Apprx.)
	emphatic		ط [ṭāʾ, tʰ]	ض [ḍād, dʰ]	ص [ṣād, sʰ]	ظ [ẓāʾ, ðʰ]		ل [lām, ɭ] (as in Allah)
Post-Alveolar/Palatal				ج ([jim, dʒ]) ◌	ش [shīn, ʃ] ◌			ي [yāʾ, j] ◌
◌Velar			ك [kāf, k]					و [wāw, w] (labial-velar)
◌Uvular			ق [qāf, q]		خ [khāʾ, χ] ^{2,3}	غ [ghayn, ɣ] ^{2,4}		
◌Pharyngeal					ح [hāʾ, h]	ع [ʿayn, ʕ]		
◌Glottal			أ [hamza, ʔ]		ه [hāʾ, h]			

¹ ت [tāʾ, t] are ك [kāf, k] are aspirated [tʰ] and [kʰ], whereas ط [ṭāʾ, tʰ] and ق [qāf, q] are unaspirated.

² In most regions, uvular fricatives of the classical period have become velar or post-velar.

³ خ the sound /χ/ (as in German “Bach”) is uvular versus /x/ (as in “loch”) is velar.

⁴ غ the sound /ɣ/ (close to French “merde”) is uvular versus /ɣ/ (close to Spanish “amigo”) is velar.

Arabic Vowels and Other Signs

Vowels	Short	ا [faṭḥa, a]	ي [kasra, i]	و [ḍamma, u]
	Long	آ [faṭḥa + alif, a:]	يَ [kasra + yāʾ, i:]	وَو [ḍamma + wāw, u:]

Other Signs:	َ [tanwīn faṭḥa, an]	ِ [tanwīn kasra, in]	ُ [tanwīn ḍamma, un]	ْ [sukūn, ʔ]	ّ [shadda, ː]
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¹This table was based off of Wikipedia’s Arabic phonology article https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Standard_Arabic_phonology#Consonants and added to by Justin Lowe. Last Updated: 2025-09-16

Arabic Alphabet Chart with all written forms ²

Independent	Final	Medial	Initial	Name	IPA	Phonology
ا	ـا	ـا	ا	alif	[aː]	(Nil. Bearer for <i>hamza</i> or sign of a long <i>ā</i>)
ب	ـب	ـب	ب	bāʾ	[b]	labial, voiced, unaspirated
ت	ـت	ـت	ت	tāʾ	[t]	dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ث	ـث	ـث	ث	thāʾ	[θ]	dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ج	ـج	ـج	ج	jīm	[d͡ʒ]	palatal, voiced, unaspirated
ح	ـح	ـح	ح	ḥāʾ	[ħ]	pharyngeal, unvoiced, unaspirated
خ	ـخ	ـخ	خ	khāʾ	[χ]	velar, unvoiced, unaspirated
د	ـد	ـد	د	dāl	[d]	dental, voiced, unaspirated
ذ	ـذ	ـذ	ذ	dhāl	[ð]	dental, voiced, unaspirated
ر	ـر	ـر	ر	rāʾ	[r]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
ز	ـز	ـز	ز	zāy	[z]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
س	ـس	ـس	س	sīn	[s]	alveolar, unvoiced, unaspirated
ش	ـش	ـش	ش	shīn	[ʃ]	palatal, unvoiced, unaspirated
ص	ـص	ـص	ص	ṣād	[sˤ]	emphatic dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ض	ـض	ـض	ض	ḍād	[dˤ]	emphatic dental, voiced, unaspirated
ط	ـط	ـط	ط	ṭāʾ	[tˤ]	emphatic dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ظ	ـظ	ـظ	ظ	ẓāʾ	[ðˤ]	emphatic dental, voiced, unaspirated
ع	ـع	ـع	ع	ʿayn	[ʕ]	pharyngeal, voiced, unaspirated
غ	ـغ	ـغ	غ	ghayn	[ɣ]	velar, voiced, unaspirated
ف	ـف	ـف	ف	fāʾ	[f]	labial, unvoiced, unaspirated
ق	ـق	ـق	ق	qāf	[q]	uvular, unvoiced, unaspirated
ك	ـك	ـك	ك	kāf	[k]	velar, unvoiced, unaspirated
ل	ـل	ـل	ل	lām	[l]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
م	ـم	ـم	م	mīm	[m]	labial, voiced, unaspirated
ن	ـن	ـن	ن	nūn	[n]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
ه	ـه	ـه	ه	hāʾ	[h]	glottal, unvoiced, unaspirated
و	ـو	ـو	و	wāw	[w]	labial-velar, voiced, unaspirated
ي	ـي	ـي	ي	yāʾ	[j]	palatal, voiced approximant
ء	ـء	ـء	ء	hamza	[ʔ]	glottal, unvoiced, unaspirated

²Last Updated: 2025-09-16 JKL

Common Arabic Ligatures ³

Ligature	Components	Transliteration
لا	لِا	lām-alif (initial/medial)
لِا	لِا	lām-alif with hamza below
لَا	لِأ	lām-alif with hamza above
لَا	لِآ	lām-alif with madda
جِج	جِج	jīm-ḥāʾ
حِج	حِج	ḥāʾ-jīm
حِم	حِم	ḥāʾ-mīm
سِج	سِج	sīn-ḥāʾ
صِج	صِج	ṣād-ḥāʾ
لِج	لِج	lām-ḥāʾ
بِسْم	بِسْم	bāʾ-sīn-mīm
اللّٰهُ	اللّٰهُ	Allah (word ligature)
صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ	صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ	ṣallā llāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam
رَسُول	صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ	ṣallā llāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam (abbreviation)
أَكْبَر	أَكْبَر	akbar
مُحَمَّد	مُحَمَّد	muḥammad
جَلَّ جَلَّالُهُ	جَلَّ جَلَّالُهُ	jalla jalāluhu

³(List generated by AI: Claude Sonnet 3.5) Last Updated: 2025-09-16 JKL